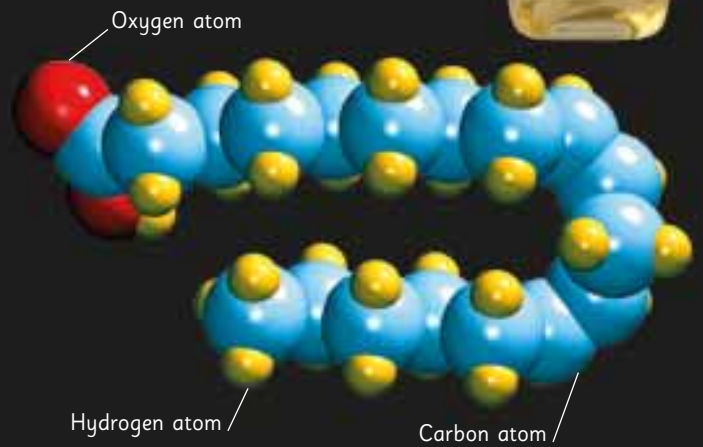


In natural substances like vegetable oil, the atoms are often joined in chains to make very large molecules. The molecules in sunflower oil contain 50 atoms each.



An atom is mostly empty space. If an atom were the size of a sports stadium, the nucleus would be the size of a marble in the middle.

The explosion
of a nuclear
bomb can create
a spectacular
“mushroom
cloud”.



When the nucleus of an atom is split, it releases a huge amount of energy. Nuclear bombs use this “atomic energy” to create huge explosions. Nuclear power stations use the energy to produce electricity.